

Baker and Howland Islands

 Population: 0

 Area: 0.5 sq miles (1.4 sq km)

The two tiny Pacific islands of Baker and Howland are surrounded by coral reefs. Uninhabited, they are a refuge for marine life, including endangered sea turtles.

Guam

 Population: 168,500

 Area: 210 sq miles (544 sq km)

This tropical island in the western Pacific Ocean is the site of important US military bases. Its indigenous people are called the Chamorro.

Chamorro-style dancing



Jarvis Island

 Population: 0

 Area: 1.5 sq miles (4.5 sq km)

A tiny, flat island in the Pacific Ocean, Jarvis brought the US riches in the 19th century thanks to guano (bird droppings), a valuable source of fertilizer. Today, Jarvis is a nature reserve.

Johnston Atoll

 Population: 0

 Area: 1 sq mile (2.6 sq km)

Four islands form this atoll in the central Pacific Ocean. North and East islands were created artificially by dredging. An uninhabited nature refuge, this atoll is an oasis for reef and bird life.

Kingman Reef

 Population: 0

 Area: 0.4 sq miles (1 sq km)

This spectacular, submerged coral reef in the north Pacific Ocean is protected. More than 200 fish species thrive here, including eels, rays, and sharks. It is also home to giant clams.

Midway Islands

 Population: 0

 Area: 5.2 sq km (2 sq miles)

Named by the US Navy for its central location between California and Japan, Midway Islands form a small coral atoll in the Pacific Ocean. Its three islands support all sorts of nesting birds, including millions of albatrosses.

Navassa Island

 Population: 0

 Area: 2 sq miles (5.2 sq km)

Preserved as a wildlife sanctuary since 1999, Navassa is a tiny US territory in the Caribbean Sea. The landscape of limestone rock and craggy coastline provides an ideal habitat for native lizards and nesting sea birds.

Northern Mariana Islands

 Population: 57,000

 Area: 184 sq miles (477 sq km)

Totaling 22 islands in the Pacific Ocean, the self-governed Northern Mariana Islands have active volcanoes and fringing coral reefs.

Palmyra Atoll

 Population: 0

 Area: 5 sq miles (12 sq km)

The Palmyra Atoll in the Pacific Ocean is a protected area. Scientists visit it to study its landscape, wildlife, and climate.



An aerial view of Palmyra Atoll

Puerto Rico

 Population: 3.2 million

 Area: 3,515 sq miles (9,104 sq km)

This vibrant island in the Caribbean Sea has both mountains and tropical forests. With a diverse population, its culture includes a mix of Spanish, US, and Afro-Caribbean traditions.

Ponce Carnival is an annual celebration in Puerto Rico.



Virgin Islands

 Population: 104,000

 Area: 137 sq miles (355 sq km)

The Virgin Islands are part of a picturesque archipelago east of Puerto Rico. Their subtropical climate, white sands, and blue waters attract many visitors. These islands are sometimes hit by powerful hurricanes, including highly destructive Hurricane Irma in 2017.

Wake Island

 Population: 0

 Area: 2.5 sq miles (6.5 sq km)

This former World War II battleground is a tiny US territory in the Pacific Ocean made up of three coral islets over an underwater volcano. The public cannot visit them, but they have an emergency landing strip for military aircraft.